

Conversation #10

CONVERSATION

TEACHER - PARENT MEETING

Teacher's note: get 6 pieces of paper, number them from 1 to 6 and have each student draw one, to see which character they will be. Check for characters that can only be women and adapt drawing.

This morning two of the teachers and two parents, besides the Principal and the Truancy Officer, have a special meeting. Both sides — the school's and the parents' — have their complaints and suggestions.

1. Math teacher: you are 23. This is your first semester as a teacher. Sam, a 13-year-old boy, is driving you crazy. He won't do his exercises, and he keeps checking you out — looking at your legs and all. That embarrasses you. Offer suggestions to solve these problems.

2. Truancy officer: you are 68 and discipline is obviously a must for you. You want to know if Dolly's mother is aware that her daughter always has an excuse to go to the toilet during class. She does that at least twice every day. What surprises you most is that she never goes to the toilet during recess. Sam is also giving you some concern because in the last couple of weeks you have seen him leave school after class and, instead of going straight home, meet with some strange fellows who hang around the school at dismissal time. You have reasons to believe they might be drug dealers. Offer suggestions to keep such unwanted people away from the school.

3. Principal: you are 35 and have just been appointed to this position. You are at the meeting because of Sam, about whom you believe the Truancy officer might well be right. The guys he has been meeting after classes are being watched by an undercover agent sent by the local authorities. You have some very good suggestions to keep the peace.

4. Sam's mother: you are 26, a single parent. Sam, your 13-year-old boy, is quite active and took after his father, a womanizer (that's one of the reasons why you and his father split). You're sorry about the situation mentioned by the Math teacher but, on the other hand, Sam claims the Math teacher keeps picking on him. You want to ask the Math teacher if it's true that she once made Sam count all the tiles on the school floor. On the other hand, you have noticed Sam has been behaving oddly in the last few weeks. He gets home late from school and can never give a convincing excuse for his tardiness. For every complaint against Sam, you have an excuse.

5. P.E. teacher: you are 30, in your prime. Concerning Dolly, you want to know why whenever you have any exercise that demands more physical effort she says she must stop because she wants to go to the toilet. In Sam's case, you think he has changed a lot, he has done a 180°. He used to be the best P.E. student you had and now he shows no interest. Insist on learning why Dolly is going to the toilet so often. You're also concerned about drugs close to the school.

6. Dolly's mother: you are 38. Dolly, who is 14, is your third and last child. She is a very shy, though affectionate, girl. She has been complaining of nightmares, where she finds herself in the desert craving for a soft drink. She has been peeing her bed and that, of course, makes her feel terribly ashamed. You have already contacted a psychologist. You don't want to share this information with others, so try to direct attention to Sam's problem.

If time allows: switch roles.

COMPOSITION

Write about a situation in your past that made your teacher and parents upset with you. How were you punished? Did you ever do it again?

Full name:_____

Theme: _____

Title: _____

[illegible]